የአይጦቹ ንጉሥ ልጅ

The Rat King's Son

Review revision: PILOT-FAMILY-R1-2026-07-05-RAT-KING

Audience: ages 5-6

Origin basis: Oromia story narrated by Merga Debelo

Story pages: 14

For adult family/cultural review

Read naturally with a child in one sitting. This reviews the story, not the child. Mark the page when wording changes aloud, attention drops, a transition feels rushed, or a moment creates confusion, fear, delight, prediction, or a request to continue.

Do not record a child's name, exact age, contact details, school, location, photo, audio, video, medical information, or other identifying details. Use the assigned anonymous session code and broad age band only.

This copy is not text or image locked. The artwork is a review candidate. Please mark visual mismatches, confusing details, cultural concerns, inconsistent characters, emotional-safety concerns, or important content lost when cropped.

Story page 1



Amharic	English
ከትልቅ ተራራ ሥር ብዙ አይጦች በአንድነት ይኖሩ ነበር። ንጉሣቸውም ልጁን እጅግ ይወደው ነበር።	Beneath a great mountain lived a large community of rats. Their king loved his son very much.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Rat community beneath a mountain; king beside young prince.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 2



Amharic	English
አንድ ቀን ንጉሡ “ልጄ ሲያድግ ጥሩ ቤተሰብ እንዲመሠርት እፈልጋለሁ። በዓለም ላይ ከሁሉ ታላቅ የሆነውን ቤተሰብ እንፈልግ” አለ።	One day the king said, “When my son grows up, I want him to build a good family. Let us seek the greatest family in the world.”

Image-text review

Expected beat: King speaking to a circle of rat elders.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 3



Amharic	English
ሽማግሌዎቹ “ከፈጣሪ የሚበልጥ ማን አለ?” ብለው ወደ ሰማይ ተመለከቱ። ንጉሡም “እንግዲያው ፈጣሪን እንጠይቅ” አለ።	“Who could be greater than the Creator?” the elders wondered, looking toward the sky. “Then we shall ask the Creator,” said the king.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Elders gazing upward from the foot of the mountain.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 4



Amharic	English
ፈጣሪ በትሕትና ሰማቸውና “ደመና ሲመጣ ሰማዩን ይሸፍናል። ምናልባት ደመናውን ትጠይቁ ይሆናል” አላቸው።	The Creator listened kindly. “When Cloud arrives, it covers the sky. Perhaps you should ask Cloud,” came the answer.

Image-text review

Expected beat: A gentle cloud spreading across the sky.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 5



Amharic	English
አይጦቹ ወደ ደመናው ሄዱ። “አንተ ከሰማይ ይልቅ ታላቅ ነህን?” ብለው ጠየቁት።	The rats hurried to Cloud. “Are you greater than the sky?” they asked.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Tiny rat elders beneath a soft, low cloud.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 6



Amharic	English
ደመናውም “እኔ ሰማዩን እሸፍናለሁ፤ ነፋስ ግን ሲነፍስ ይበትነኛል” አለ። “ከእኔ ይልቅ ነፋስን ጠይቁ።”	“I can cover the sky,” said Cloud, “but Wind scatters me whenever it blows. Ask Wind, who is stronger than I am.”

Image-text review

Expected beat: Wind gently parting the cloud as rats hold their hats.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 7



Amharic	English
አይጦቹ ነፋስን ተከትለው “አንተ ከሁሉ ታላቅ ነህን?” አሉት። ነፋሱ ዙሪያቸውን እየዞረ ሳቀ።	The rats followed the breeze. “Are you the greatest of all?” they asked. Wind swirled around them with a laugh.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Playful wind curling around travelling rat elders.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 8



Amharic	English
“ደመናን ማባረር እችላለሁ፤ ተራራን ግን ከቦታው ማንቀሳቀስ አልችልም” አለ ነፋሱ። “ከእኔ ይልቅ ተራራን ጠይቁ” አላቸው።	“I can chase Cloud away,” said Wind, “but I cannot move Mountain from its place. Ask Mountain, who is greater than I am.”

Image-text review

Expected beat: Wind bending trees while the mountain stands calmly.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 9



Amharic	English
ሽማግሌዎቹ ወደ ተራራው ቀርበው “አንተ ከነፋስ ይልቅ ታላቅ ነህን?” አሉ። ተራራውም በጥልቅ ድምፅ መለሰ።	The elders stood before Mountain. “Are you greater than Wind?” they called. Mountain answered in a deep voice.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Rat elders at the immense but friendly mountain face.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 10



Amharic	English
“ነፋስ አያንቀሳቅሰኝም፤ ነገር ግን ትንሹ የዱር አይጥ በውስጤ መንገድ ይቆፍራል” አለ ተራራው። “እርሱ የማልችለውን ይችላል።”	“Wind cannot move me,” said Mountain, “yet a little bush rat digs pathways through me. He can do something I cannot.”

Image-text review

Expected beat: Cutaway view of a small bush rat making a tunnel.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 11



Amharic	English
ሽማግሌዎቹ ተደነቁ። በጉዟቸው ሁሉ ከትልቅ ወደ ትልቅ ሲፈልጉ፣ መልሱ ከቤታቸው አጠገብ ነበር።	The elders were amazed. They had travelled far in search of greatness, only to find the answer close to home.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Elders exchanging surprised smiles near the tunnel entrance.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 12



Amharic	English
ወደ ንጉሡ ተመልሰው ያዩትን ሁሉ ነገሩት። “እያንዳንዱ የሚችለው የተለየ ነገር አለ” አሉት።	They returned and told the king everything. “Each one has a different kind of strength,” they said.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Elders recounting the journey to king and prince.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 13



Amharic	English
ንጉሡ ከዱር አይጦቹ ቤተሰብ ጋር ተዋወቀ። ልጆቻቸውም አብረው ሲጫወቱና ሲማማሩ ደስ አላቸው።	The king met the bush-rat family. Their children enjoyed playing, learning, and spending time together.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Two rat families sharing food while the young rats play.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Story page 14



Amharic	English
ዓመታት ካለፉ በኋላ ልጆቹ አድገው ቤተሰብ መሠረቱ። ንጉሡም “ታላቅነት ሌሎችን በመብለጥ ሳይሆን ያለንን መልካም ነገር በማወቅ ነው” ብሎ ተማረ።	Years later, the young rats grew up and made a family of their own. The king learned that greatness is not being above everyone else; it is recognising the good each one carries.

Image-text review

Expected beat: Grown rat couple with both families celebrating warmly.
Does the picture match both texts? Are characters, setting, clothing, objects, expressions and scale clear and consistent? Any cultural, safety, cropping or child-appeal concern?

Adult text and image notes

Session scorecard

Anonymous session code: _____ Broad age band: 3-4 / 5-6

Language: Amharic / English Adult role: parent / caregiver / educator / other

Completed story: Yes / No

Rate 1 (serious problem) to 5 (ready), or mark N/A.

Measure	1-5	Page/evidence
Language sounded natural aloud		
Sentences were easy to read		
Child followed the story flow		
Page pacing felt unhurried		
Conflict felt emotionally safe		
Ending felt clear and satisfying		
Child remained interested		
Images match both language versions		
Characters remain visually consistent		
Culture and setting feel respectful		
Images remain clear when cropped		

Observations and recommendation

Words changed aloud; confusing or rushed pages; child questions; delight or prediction; fear or discomfort; remembered part; suggested revision:

Recommendation: Pass / Revise wording / Revise page flow / Reconsider age band / Cultural review / Safety review / Replace

Return this adult scorecard through the owner's private route. Remove identifying child details before submission.